INTERNATIONAL MARITIME ORGANIZATION

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ROUTEING MEASURES AND MANDATORY SHIP REPORTING SYSTEMS

Preliminary assessment of proposals on ships' routeing and ship reporting systems

Note by the Chair

1 The fifty-first session of the Sub-Committee on Safety of Navigation, after extensive discussion on the quality of ships' routeing proposals, agreed that a preliminary assessment of proposals would be made by the Chair in consultation with the Secretariat and the Chair of the Ships' Routeing Working Group (NAV 51/19, paragraph 3.4). Such a preliminary assessment would follow the general criteria in MSC/Circ.1060, including MSC.1/Circ.1060/Add.1, and would not address the technical aspects of the proposal. The results of the assessment would then be made available to the Sub-Committee by means of a working paper.

2 Accordingly, preliminary assessments of the ships' routeing and ship reporting system proposals submitted for consideration at NCSR 9 are set out in annexes 1 and 2, respectively.

3 Given the difficulties envisaged for the unprecedented consideration of proposals in a virtual form and taking into account that the meeting of the Experts Group on Ships' Routeing will be held in advance of the plenary session of NCSR 9, the information contained in the annexes includes also additional comments by the Chair to facilitate the consideration of the proposals.

Action requested of the Sub-Committee

4 The Sub-Committee is invited to note the information provided and take it into account during the consideration of ships' routeing and ship reporting system proposals submitted at NCSR 9.

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NEW TECHNOLOGIES FOR GREENER SHIPPING

ANNEX 1

TRAFFIC SEPARATION SCHEMES AND ROUTEING MEASURES OTHER THAN TRAFFIC SEPARATION SCHEMES

Adherence to the requirements are marked as "✓", while sections in unclear or questionable state are marked as "U", with explanatory notes provided in footnotes as necessary.

	Summary						Description of the Area			Cooperation between States	Traffic considerations						Marine environmental considerations		Mandatory routeing systems			Position-fixing	Miscellaneous information				Standard format	Other guidance "U" only, if observed	
Document/ proponent	Objectives	Demonstrated need	Reason for proposal preferred	History of incidents	Applicability	Impact on shipping	Location (positions)	Reference chart details	Chartlet (appropriate one)	Cooperation between States	Following existing Traffic patterns	Aids to navigation	Information on traffic patterns	Hydrographic surveys and charts (adequacy)	Alternative measure	Offshore structures	Environmental factors	Prevent/reduce risk	Sufficient justification	Adverse effect to ports and harbours (inc. TSS)	Limited to what is essential	Aids or services	Fishing ground, activities, and foreseeable changes in the traffic pattern	Other measures taken	Consultations with mariners and other users	Monitoring compliance and actions taken (inc. TSS)	Correct format for description of proposed system (GPSR)	Adherence to other guidelines than GPSR & MSC.1/Circ.1060	Remarks
NCSR 9/3 (Ukraine)	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓	N/A	N/A	N/A	✓	✓	U[1]	✓	✓	✓	-	Amendments of existing TSS and associated measures, "In the approaches to the ports of Odessa and Ilichevsk", "Between the ports of Odessa and Ilichevsk", Ukraine
Additional comments	In view of the degree of conformance to the guidance, the proposal could be considered for finalization, subject to scrutiny during the session.																												

[1] A summary of other measures taken in the area of the proposed system was not provided.

	Summary						Description of the Area			Cooperation between States	Traffic considerations						Marine environmental considerations		Mandatory routeing systems			Position-fixing	Miscellaneous information				Standard format	Other guidance "U" only, if observed	
Document/ proponent	Objectives	Demonstrated need	Reason for proposal preferred	History of incidents	Applicability	Impact on shipping	Location (positions)	Reference chart details	Chartlet (appropriate one)	Cooperation between States	Following existing Traffic patterns	Aids to navigation	Information on traffic patterns	Hydrographic surveys and charts (adequacy)	Alternative measure	Offshore structures	Environmental factors	Prevent/reduce risk	Sufficient justification	Adverse effect to ports and harbours (inc. TSS)	Limited to what is essential	Aids or services	Fishing ground, activities, and foreseeable changes in the traffic pattern	Other measures taken	Consultations with mariners and other users	Monitoring compliance and actions taken (inc. TSS)	Correct format for description of proposed system (GPSR)	Adherence to other guidelines than GPSR & MSC.1/Circ.1060	Remarks
NCSR 9/3/1 (Brazil)	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓	U[2]	✓	✓	U[3]	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓	U[4]	✓	✓	✓	N/A	N/A	N/A	✓	✓	U[5]	✓	N/A	✓	-	Area to be Avoided off the Brazilian Southeast Coast
Additional comments	Some parts of the proposal are unclear. Given the extensive size of the proposed ATBA, the complexity of the operations and the number of FPSOs within the area, resolving the unclear elements by virtual means may be challenging, particularly when determining the most proportionate minimum measure to achieve the stated objective. GPSR, paragraph 1.2.4 provides the objective of a routeing system when established in areas of concentrated offshore exploration or exploitation; that is to organize safe traffic flow, and not to block the passage in a large area. Alternative options for organizing the traffic flow by other means, such as to provide a safe corridor within the very large area, could also be carefully considered. In view of this, an analysis of the clustered very minimum ATBAs outlined in annex 2, particularly figures 2 to 4 with two or more smaller ATBAs, may provide potential alternatives to the proposed ATBA. Based on the result of the considerations, finalization of the proposal may not be possible during the virtual meeting, particularly if alternative ATBAs are to be considered.																												

[2] Given the size of the proposed ATBA, impact on shipping should be carefully considered. Annex 2 of the proposal outlines some reduced impact options which could provide a solid base for discussions.

[3] The shape of proposed area seems inconsistent throughout the document.

[4] Alternative measures which allow the orderly safe passage in the middle with no FPSOs could have been provided.

[5] A summary of other measures taken in the area of the proposed system was not provided. This could include, but not be limited to: graphical details of safety zones, guard boats, radio warnings and warning lights for approaching ships.

	Summary						Description of the Area			Cooperation between States	Traffic considerations						Marine environmental considerations		Mandatory routeing systems			Position-fixing	Miscellaneous information				Standard format	Other guidance "U" only, if observed	
Document/ proponent	Objectives	Demonstrated need	Reason for proposal preferred	History of incidents	Applicability	Impact on shipping	Location (positions)	Reference chart details	Chartlet (appropriate one)	Cooperation between States	Following existing Traffic patterns	Aids to navigation	Information on traffic patterns	Hydrographic surveys and charts (adequacy)	Alternative measure	Offshore structures	Environmental factors	Prevent/reduce risk	Sufficient justification	Adverse effect to ports and harbours (inc. TSS)	Limited to what is essential	Aids or services	Fishing ground, activities, and foreseeable changes in the traffic pattern	Other measures taken	Consultations with mariners and other users	Monitoring compliance and actions taken (inc. TSS)	Correct format for description of proposed system (GPSR)	Adherence to other guidelines than GPSR & MSC.1/Circ.1060	Remarks
NCSR 9/3/2 (Japan)	✓	✓	U[6]	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓	U[7]	✓	✓	✓	N/A	N/A	N/A	✓	✓	N/A	✓	N/A	✓	-	Recommended route off Cape Shio-no-Misaki
Additional comments	In view of the degree of conformance to the guidance, the proposal could be considered for finalization, subject to scrutiny during the session. Suitability of the proposed measure against the possible establishment of a TSS could be considered.																												

6 Further information could be beneficial to better understand the reasons why the proposed system is preferred.

7 The explanation of alternative measures might not be sufficient. For example, a comparison with the TSS option could be presented.

	Summary						Description of the Area			Cooperation between States	Traffic considerations						Marine environmental considerations		Mandatory routeing systems			Position-fixing	Miscellaneous information				Standard format	Other guidance "U" only, if observed	
Document/ proponent	Objectives	Demonstrated need	Reason for proposal preferred	History of incidents	Applicability	Impact on shipping	Location (positions)	Reference chart details	Chartlet (appropriate one)	Cooperation between States	Following existing Traffic patterns	Aids to navigation	Information on traffic patterns	Hydrographic surveys and charts (adequacy)	Alternative measure	Offshore structures	Environmental factors	Prevent/reduce risk	Sufficient justification	Adverse effect to ports and harbours (inc. TSS)	Limited to what is essential	Aids or services	Fishing ground, activities, and foreseeable changes in the traffic pattern	Other measures taken	Consultations with mariners and other users	Monitoring compliance and actions taken (inc. TSS)	Correct format for description of proposed system (GPSR)	Adherence to other guidelines than GPSR & MSC.1/Circ.1060	Remarks
NCSR 9/3/3 (United States)	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓	U[8]	N/A	✓	✓	✓	✓	U[9]	✓	U[10]	✓	N/A	N/A	N/A	✓	✓	✓	✓	N/A	✓	U[11]	ATBA Off the California Coast
Additional comments	This proposal should be considered along with the associated proposal of amendment of the TSS (NCSR 9/3/4), taking into account the requirements and impact of both measures (ATBA expansion on top of TSS expansion). Given the lack of environmental expertise and competence of the Sub-Committee and the large area of expansion of the ATBA, this consideration may be important. Consideration of the extensive proposed ATBA in virtual form may be challenging.																												

8 There is no indication in the chartlets of the position numbers, which makes it difficult to consider.

9 The explanation on alternative measures might not be sufficient. For example, the effectiveness of implementing the expanded ATBA alone without extending the TSS (and vice versa) could be more elaborated.

10 Given the magnitude of the large area of expansion, consideration of environmental factors, including wildlife protection measures, may require the expertise of the appropriate IMO organ (i.e. MEPC) to confirm the sensitivity of the area proposed to be expanded.

11 According to MSC.1/Circ.1608, paragraph 3.1, for proposals primarily related to matters of protection of the marine wildlife, the proponents should consider first a submission to MEPC with a view to establishing PSSAs and/or associated protective measures, as appropriate. The Sub-Committee may lack the expertise to have a clear understanding of the particular sensitivity of the large area proposed.

	Summary						Description of the Area			Cooperation between States	Traffic considerations						Marine environmental considerations		Mandatory routeing systems			Position-fixing	Miscellaneous information				Standard format	Other guidance "U" only, if observed	
Document/ proponent	Objectives	Demonstrated need	Reason for proposal preferred	History of incidents	Applicability	Impact on shipping	Location (positions)	Reference chart details	Chartlet (appropriate one)	Cooperation between States	Following existing Traffic patterns	Aids to navigation	Information on traffic patterns	Hydrographic surveys and charts (adequacy)	Alternative measure	Offshore structures	Environmental factors	Prevent/reduce risk	Sufficient justification	Adverse effect to ports and harbours (inc. TSS)	Limited to what is essential	Aids or services	Fishing ground, activities, and foreseeable changes in the traffic pattern	Other measures taken	Consultations with mariners and other users	Monitoring compliance and actions taken (inc. TSS)	Correct format for description of proposed system (GPSR)	Adherence to other guidelines than GPSR & MSC.1/Circ.1060	Remarks
NCSR 9/3/4 (United States)	✓	✓	✓	U [12]	✓	✓	✓	✓	U [13]	N/A	✓	✓	✓	✓	U [14]	✓	✓ [15]	✓	N/A	N/A	N/A	✓	✓	✓	✓	N/A	✓	U [16]	Amendment of TSS *In the Santa Barbara Channel*
Additional comments	This proposal should be considered along with the associated proposal of amendment to the ATBA (NCSR 9/3/3), taking into account the requirements and impact of both measures (ATBA expansion on top of TSS expansion). Two independent measures to enhance each existing measure for the same protection objective are presented, without assessment of effectiveness for each measure, if implemented alone. Both ATBA and TSS expansion/extension seem effective enough to further enhance the protection of wildlife if only one of these alone is implemented (given the existing presence of ATBA and TSS), and may be lacking justification of requirements of both extensions.																												

12 The data presented seems to be related to incidents from a wide-ranging area other than the specific TSS extension area, making it difficult to understand the justification for the proposed 13 miles extension and its effects.

13 A suitable large scale chartlet was not provided. There is no indication in the chartlets of the position numbers, which makes it difficult to consider.

14 The explanation on alternative measures might not be sufficient. For example, the effectiveness of implementing the extended TSS alone without the expanded ATBA (and vice versa) could be more elaborated.

15 It may be difficult for the Sub-Committee to consider the proportionality of the proposed measure with regard to environmental sensitivity of the proposed area. However, given the relatively small impact to shipping (opposed to the large ATBA expansion), for the purpose of the TSS extension, it may be acceptable.

16 According to MSC.1/Circ.1608, paragraph 3.1, for proposals primarily related to matters of protection of the marine wildlife, the proponents should consider first a submission to MEPC with a view to establishing PSSAs and/or associated protective measures, as appropriate. The Sub-Committee may lack the expertise to have a clear understanding of the particular sensitivity of the traffic lanes proposed to be extended.

	Summary						Description of the Area			Cooperation between States	Traffic considerations						Marine environmental considerations		Mandatory routeing systems			Position-fixing	Miscellaneous information				Standard format	Other guidance "U" only, if observed	
Document/ proponent	Objectives	Demonstrated need	Reason for proposal preferred	History of incidents	Applicability	Impact on shipping	Location (positions)	Reference chart details	Chartlet (appropriate one)	Cooperation between States	Following existing Traffic patterns	Aids to navigation	Information on traffic patterns	Hydrographic surveys and charts (adequacy)	Alternative measure	Offshore structures	Environmental factors	Prevent/reduce risk	Sufficient justification	Adverse effect to ports and harbours (inc. TSS)	Limited to what is essential	Aids or services	Fishing ground, activities, and foreseeable changes in the traffic pattern	Other measures taken	Consultations with mariners and other users	Monitoring compliance and actions taken (inc. TSS)	Correct format for description of proposed system (GPSR)	Adherence to other guidelines than GPSR & MSC.1/Circ.1060	Remarks
NCSR 9/3/5 (United States)	✓	✓	✓	U[17]	✓	✓	✓	✓	U[18]	N/A	✓	✓	✓	U[19]	✓	U[20]	✓[21]	✓	N/A	N/A	N/A	✓	✓	✓	U[22]	N/A	✓	U[23]	No anchoring area in the southern portion of Pulley Ridge off the coast of Florida
Additional comments	The proposal is unclear in a number of areas. However, in view of the presence of an existing PSSA and no anchoring areas as its associated measure in relatively close proximity, the Sub-Committee may consider the explanation for not seeking confirmation of environmental sensitivity from MEPC sufficient. On the basis that the proposal is not a mandatory measure, therefore, the proposal could be considered for finalization, subject to challenging virtual consideration of geographical representations.																												

17 Not provided.

18 No suitable large scale chartlet was provided.

19 Not provided.

20 Not provided.

21 It is difficult for the Sub-Committee to consider the proportionality of the proposed measure with regard to environmental factors in the proposed area. However, given the close proximity to the existing PSSA and associated no anchoring areas, it may be considered acceptable.

22 Not provided.

23 MSC.1/Circ.1608 may have been observed. However, the Sub-Committee may lack the expertise to have a clear understanding of the particular sensitivity of the area proposed. Given the close proximity to already designated PSSA and that the proposal is not mandatory prohibition of anchoring, consideration of proportionality may be possible.

Document/ proponent	Summary						Description of the Area			Cooperation between States	Traffic considerations						Marine environmental considerations		Mandatory routeing systems			Position-fixing	Miscellaneous information				Standard format	Other guidance "U" only, if observed	Remarks
	Objectives	Demonstrated need	Reason for proposal preferred	History of incidents	Applicability	Impact on shipping	Location (positions)	Reference chart details	Chartlet (appropriate one)	Cooperation between States	Following existing Traffic patterns	Aids to navigation	Information on traffic patterns	Hydrographic surveys and charts (adequacy)	Alternative measure	Offshore structures	Environmental factors	Prevent/reduce risk	Sufficient justification	Adverse effect to ports and harbours (inc. TSS)	Limited to what is essential	Aids or services	Fishing ground, activities, and foreseeable changes in the traffic pattern	Other measures taken	Consultations with mariners and other users	Monitoring compliance and actions taken (inc. TSS)	Correct format for description of proposed system (GPSR)	Adherence to other guidelines than GPSR & MSC.1/Circ.1060	
NCSR 9/3/6 (France)	The intent of this document is not clear given the absence of explanations and objectives for proposals to amend 11 different routeing measures. If the proposal is considered to be a "correction" of existing errors, the proponent could be invited to bring this to the attention of the Secretariat for "rectification of errors". However, if the proposal is to update the details of the charts historically used to delineate the routeing measures at the time of adoption, updating these details is not possible as the current updated charts were not used to delineate existing measures a number of years ago. The chart details listed, in particular applicable datum references, are a reflection of what had been used at the time of adoption which remain until other recent charts being used for the purpose of amendments to the original measures.																												Updates to Ushant TSS and French nautical charts

	Summary						Description of the Area			Cooperation between States	Traffic considerations						Marine environmental considerations		Mandatory routeing systems			Position-fixing	Miscellaneous information				Standard format	Other guidance "U" only, if observed	
Document/ proponent	Objectives	Demonstrated need	Reason for proposal preferred	History of incidents	Applicability	Impact on shipping	Location (positions)	Reference chart details	Chartlet (appropriate one)	Cooperation between States	Following existing Traffic patterns	Aids to navigation	Information on traffic patterns	Hydrographic surveys and charts (adequacy)	Alternative measure	Offshore structures	Environmental factors	Prevent/reduce risk	Sufficient justification	Adverse effect to ports and harbours (inc. TSS)	Limited to what is essential	Aids or services	Fishing ground, activities, and foreseeable changes in the traffic pattern	Other measures taken	Consultations with mariners and other users	Monitoring compliance and actions taken (inc. TSS)	Correct format for description of proposed system (GPSR)	Adherence to other guidelines than GPSR & MSC.1/Circ.1060	Remarks
NCSR 9/3/7 (United Kingdom)	✓	✓	✓	U [24]	✓ [25]	✓	✓	✓	U [26]	N/A	N/A	U [27]	✓	✓ [28]	U [29]	✓	U [30]	✓	N/A	N/A	N/A	U [31]	✓	✓ [32]	✓	N/A	✓	-	Amendment of existing ATBA and PA *In the region of the Shetland Islands*
Additional comments	The proposal is unclear in several areas. It may be challenging to finalize the proposal within the limited amount of time and the limitations associated with the consideration in virtual format. However, these may be minor enough which, if clarified during the session, could satisfy. The issue of misuse of the PA seems to be one of the implementation issues. Means to improve implementation by other measures than converting PAs to ATBA, including the designation of possible national measures, could be explored and presented, before finalization.																												

24 Not provided.
25 Rational of why 5000GT is used to cap may be desirable.
26 There is no indication in the chartlets of the position numbers, which makes it difficult to consider.
27 Not provided.
28 Not provided, however, given the depth of the area, it may be less relevant.
29 Means to improve implementation by other measures than converting PA to ATBA may need to be explored and presented.
30 Might not be sufficient.
31 Not provided.
32 Presentation of other measures to improve the implementation of PAs (or avoid their misuse) could be desirable.

	Summary						Description of the Area			Cooperation between States	Traffic considerations						Marine environmental considerations		Mandatory routeing systems			Position-fixing	Miscellaneous information				Standard format	Other guidance "U" only, if observed	
Document/ proponent	Objectives	Demonstrated need	Reason for proposal preferred	History of incidents	Applicability	Impact on shipping	Location (positions)	Reference chart details	Chartlet (appropriate one)	Cooperation between States	Following existing Traffic patterns	Aids to navigation	Information on traffic patterns	Hydrographic surveys and charts (adequacy)	Alternative measure	Offshore structures	Environmental factors	Prevent/reduce risk	Sufficient justification	Adverse effect to ports and harbours (inc. TSS)	Limited to what is essential	Aids or services	Fishing ground, activities, and foreseeable changes in the traffic pattern	Other measures taken	Consultations with mariners and other users	Monitoring compliance and actions taken (inc. TSS)	Correct format for description of proposed system (GPSR)	Adherence to other guidelines than GPSR & MSC.1/Circ.1060	Remarks
NCSR 9/3/9 (Denmark et al.)	✓	U[33]	N/A	U[34]	✓	✓	✓	N/A	U[35]	✓	N/A	N/A	U[36]	N/A[37]	N/A	N/A	✓	✓	N/A	N/A	N/A	✓	N/A	✓	U[38]	N/A	✓	-	Recommendation on navigation for containerships in TSSs Off Vlieland, Terschelling-German Bight, Off Friesland and German Bight western approach .
Additional comments	Several unclarities/shortfalls are pointed out, however, these may be minor enough which, if clarified during the session, could satisfy. Since the proposal is for a recommendation associated to the existing routeing systems, rather than the routeing system itself, these points may be clarified and finalized during the session, and less challenging for virtual consideration.																												

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33 Not provided.

34 It is not clear if other incidents other than the one mentioned have occurred.

35 Indication of applicable TSSs in the chatlets would be helpful.

36 More details on existing container ship traffic may be beneficial.

37 Might not be essential but it would be helpful if the depth information is provided considering the aspect of bottom contact of container ships.

38 Consultations with users of the area is not clear.

ANNEX 2

SHIP REPORTING SYSTEMS

Document	Objectives	Demonstrated need	Categories of ships	Traffic characteristics/ Environment aspects	Geographical coverage	Report format/Content	Report timing	Information to be provided; procedures	Comm. requirements	Rules and regs. in force	Shore-based facilities	Existing measures; why inadequate	Backup procedures	Emergency Plan	Measures for non-compliance	Implementation date	Correct format	Reference to relevant data exchange standard	Cyber-risk management guidelines	Automated ship reporting by electronic means	Adherence to res A.851(20)	Draft text for resolution	Adherence to other applicable Guidelines	Remarks
NCSR 9/3/8 (United Kingdom)	✓	U[1]	✓	✓	✓	U[2]	✓	U[3]	U[4]	U[5]	✓	U[6]	✓	U[7]	✓	✓	U[8]	✓[9]	✓[10]	U[11]	U[12]	✓	U[13]	Mandatory ship reporting system in the Pentland Firth

1 It is unclear why the reporting has to be made mandatory, while other options to achieve the same objective were not explored or adequately explained, including the recommendation to report also at the exit without mandating the report.

2 Key elements of the reporting system, format and procedure set out in section 3, may be confusing, particularly what needs to be reported through voice and when for each type of report. It appears that VHF voice reporting contents include a number of non-essential items to be reported including Inmarsat mobile number, manufacturer and model etc. which may need to be reconsidered.

3 Contents of the report do not seem to be limited to essential information to achieve the stated objective (resolution A.851(20), paragraph 1.1.1).

4 Noting that the objective of the proposal is the continuous monitoring and tracking of vessels (NCSR 9/3/8, paragraph 12), justification of voice communication requirement may not be sufficient, whereas sufficient AIS monitoring coverage is provided.

5 There is no information about relevant rules and regulations in force in the area of the proposed system, in particular, regarding shore-based services for traffic safety.

6 The proposal does not explain other national measures which could also contribute to the same objectives, without having to compel ships to participate in a mandatory system.

7 Existence of an emergency plan is acknowledged without providing a description (resolution MSC.433(98), paragraph 3.3.12).

8 Some of the sections of the reporting format may not be necessary for the objectives of the system (resolution A.851(20), paragraph 2.1).

9 Additional information on relevant data exchange standards may be desirable.

10 Provided, however, the current version of circular is not referenced.

11 Justification of mandating voice reporting may not be sufficient, taking into account other available automated means of reporting (e.g. AIS).

12 Contents of the report do not seem to be limited to essential information to achieve the stated objective.

13 Consequential draft amendments to existing *Recommendations on navigation around the United Kingdom coast* are not provided.

Document	Objectives	Demonstrated need	Categories of ships	Traffic characteristics/ Environment aspects	Geographical coverage	Report format/Content	Report timing	Information to be provided; procedures	Comm. requirements	Rules and regs. in force	Shore-based facilities	Existing measures; why inadequate	Backup procedures	Emergency Plan	Measures for non-compliance	Implementation date	Correct format	Reference to relevant data exchange standard	Cyber-risk management guidelines	Automated ship reporting by electronic means	Adherence to res A.851(20)	Draft text for resolution	Adherence to other applicable Guidelines	Remarks
Additional comments	The proposal is unclear in many areas which may make consideration challenging at this session, taking also into account the limitations of the virtual meeting. The proposal is made following the recommendation by a company stating that the benefits of the scheme being mandatory would considerably enhance safety of navigation in the area, without the need for additional Coastguard Operations Centre equipment or staff. The mandatory implementation of the ship reporting system, particularly after the adoption of resolution MSC.433(98), should ideally be considered only after observing the effectiveness of implementable national measures to achieve the same objective. The investigation report suggests a number of improvements in existing voluntary system in its ability to monitor the traffic before having to resort to a new IMO mandatory instrument. The investigation reported seems to have been conducted before the Guidelines and criteria for ship reporting was revised (now resolution MSC.433(98)) and what is now required may not be adequately addressed in the investigation and the proposal made upon it. MAREP reporting system, in its current voluntary form, may be compliant with resolution MSC.433(98), where reporting systems should be automated using available electronic means without mandating the manual VHF reporting. It may be more appropriate to expand the scope of voluntary MAREP, without making it mandatory, including the receipt of exist report with enhanced VTS shore-based monitoring of transit ships.																							